

DHANASHREE DHANAWADE

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OBJECTIVE

Game Designer and VR Developer with an MSc in Computer Games, skilled in Unity, Unreal Engine, and Blender. Focused on crafting immersive, narrative-driven experiences that blend storytelling, puzzles, and player engagement.

EDUCATION

Queen Mary University of London, Mile End, United Kingdom
Msc Computer Games

(Sep 2024 – Sep 2025)

University of Mumbai- Vishwaniketan's Institute of Technology, Khopoli, Raigad, India
BE in Computer Science

(Aug 2019 – Jun 2022)
(CGPA:7.86/10)

PROJECTS

A Day in My Life – Narrative VR Puzzle Game

Unity | C# | Blender | Oculus VR | Aug 2025

- Designed and developed a **single-player VR narrative game** exploring memory, identity, and self-discovery through symbolic puzzles and poetic narration.
- Built **core gameplay loop**: exploration, puzzle-solving, and progression, ensuring mechanics doubled as narrative metaphors.
- Integrated **VR interactions** (grabbing, climbing, rotating objects) with Unity XR Toolkit for intuitive embodiment.
- Created optimized 3D assets in Blender and implemented performance improvements (terrain, particle effects) for smooth VR play.
- Conducted **playtesting with peers**, receiving strong feedback on immersion and story clarity.

Treasure Sea-ker – 3D Underwater Platformer

Unity | C# | Unity UI Toolkit | GitHub | Oct – Nov 2024

Coordinated in the development of a 3D underwater platformer game focused on exploration, treasure hunting, and enemy combat.

- Designed and implemented various **UI systems**: main menu settings, pause menu settings, oxygen bar, inventory, and minimap.
- Enhanced player experience through dynamic UI feedback, including oxygen level tracking and interactive inventory management.
- Developed systems using Unity UI Toolkit and scripted in C# for optimized performance.
- Collaborated on game mechanics and supported integration of features like the grappling gun.

Procedural Forest Generator with Autonomous Agents

Unity | C# | 2025

- Designed and implemented a procedural forest generation system using cellular automata and a drunken walk algorithm for dynamic path creation.
- Developed autonomous agent AI that navigates generated terrain using wander and avoidance behaviour, mimicking real-world NPC systems.
- Engineered configurable map density, pathfinding, and generation parameters, demonstrating strong grasp of gameplay systems programming.
- Focused on system scalability, runtime efficiency, and modular design, applying real-world engineering principles to procedural gameplay.

Dual-Control (C++) — Custom 2D Game Engine Project

C++ | VS Code | Apr – May 2025

2D Action Game. Developed a basic yet fully functional 2D game from scratch using pure C++ and Visual Studio Code, without any pre-built game engine.

- Designed core gameplay involving a player navigating challenges using **WASD** keys.
- Implemented an **input toggling system**: pressing "Enter" dynamically switches control between **WASD** and **Arrow keys**, as seen in the video demo.
- Developed custom logic for character movement, collision detection, and input handling.
- Focused on memory management and real-time event handling at a low level.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Technical Support Analyst | Tata Consultancy Services, Mumbai (Jul 2022 – Aug 2024)

- Collaborated with cross-functional teams of developers and designers to troubleshoot and resolve large-scale technical issues, experience directly applicable to debugging gameplay systems and ensuring smooth user experience.
- Diagnosed and optimized system performance, similar to profiling and resolving bottlenecks in real-time game engines.
- Worked in Agile environments using tools like JIRA, Confluence, and Trello, strengthening iteration cycles, sprint planning, and feature tracking relevant to game development pipelines.
- Provided end-user support and technical documentation, skills that translate to improving player experience, QA testing, and supporting clear communication between design and engineering teams.
- Managed multiple issues simultaneously under tight deadlines, a discipline directly transferable to managing production milestones in game design.
- Applied Kotlin and SQL for data management, showcasing adaptability to new programming languages and structured problem-solving for gameplay systems and backend features.

TECHNICAL STRENGTHS

- Game Engines:** Unreal Engine, Unity
- UI Tools:** Unity UI Toolkit, Unreal UMG, Figma
- Scripting:** C# (Unity), C++
- Languages:** Python, C++, C#
- Version Control:** Git
- Collaboration:** Trello, Confluence, JIRA
- 3D Modelling Software:** Blender 2.8
- Level Design, Narrative Design, Puzzle Design.

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- Completed a course and training in creating animation, rigging and rendering in Blender 2.8 software.
- Participation in events like **itch.io** game jams and AI in games conferences.
- Part of a Women in Games Community.
- Facilitated in National Level Project and Poster Competition.
- Was member of Arts Club; The sketches of mine were posted on the official Instagram page of our college.